The Guardian

onestopenglish

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary

1 Warmer

a. Circle the words in *italics* that make the sentences true.

1. *Petrol / diesel / electric / hybrid* cars are best for the planet.
2. *Petrol / diesel / electric / hybrid* cars cost the most money.
3. Most people here have a *petrol / diesel / electric / hybrid* car.
4. *Petrol / diesel / electric / hybrid* cars are the cars of the future.
5. I have a *petrol / diesel / electric / hybrid* car.

2 Key words

a. Write the words from the wordpools next to the definitions below. Then find and highlight them in the article to read them in context.

design	growing	replace	shape	space

1. the outer form of something ____________________
2. use something for doing the same job as something that was used before ____________________
3. the way that something is made so that it works in a certain way or has a certain look ____________________
4. an area for something ____________________
5. getting bigger and larger ____________________

digitization	emissions	fewer	materials	reducing

6. substances, especially gas, that go into the air ____________________
7. making something smaller or less in size, amount, importance, etc. ____________________
8. a smaller number than before ____________________
9. substances, especially ones used for a particular purpose, such as bricks, plastic, metal, etc. ____________________
10. the integration of digital technologies into everyday life ____________________

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary

b. Use some of the key words above to complete these sentences.

1. No one thought that the email would completely ______________________ the traditional business letter.
2. Squares, circles, and triangles are types of ______________________.
3. There are ______________________ students in our class this year: 15 instead of 18.
4. We are ______________________ the cost of our services by fifty per cent.
5. The new hotel has a very unusual shape and ______________________.

The Guardian

onestopenglish

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary

Jasper Jolly

11 June, 2022

1 A mechanic from 100 years ago would probably understand how a petrol car from today works. An internal combustion engine at the front turns the wheels, and the driver sits behind a steering wheel.

2 Electric cars change everything. The shape of the car is different because there is no large engine, exhaust gas handling, or driveshaft. Soon, digital technology will replace everything from rear-view mirrors to the human driver. The car industry is seeing many changes.

'The skateboard'

3 There is a new design freedom. Look at the front of a Tesla – it doesn't need a grille to give air to the engine.

4 Electric cars have a "skateboard" design, with a flat bed of batteries and wheels and motors at either end. Electric motors are smaller than internal combustion engines, so they don't need a large bonnet in front of the driver.

More interior space

5 The skateboard means electric cars are a few centimetres taller. Many carmakers started with large sports utility vehicles (SUVs) first so they can put in more batteries. But there is also more space for passengers.

6 In combustion engine cars, "the mechanics needed a lot of space," says Mark Adams, design director for Vauxhall-Opel.

7 Adams say the electric cars could finally stop car companies making bigger and bigger SUVs. "The days of the growing cars are gone," he says.

8 Citroën already has a smaller option: the Ami is a tiny, simple two-seater car for cities. In the UK, it will cost under £8,000.

Fewer car parts

9 Zero exhaust emissions is one big change. Reducing waste is another. This is possible by using fewer parts with fewer complicated mixes of materials.

10 A car's front grille can contain 10 to 15 pieces. Not having a grille makes it easier to recycle the car. BMW's i Vision Circular is made with only seven materials – all recyclable.

Forget the steering wheel

11 Future cars will probably not need a steering wheel. Driverless cars are already on the roads.

12 Changing "one big thing changes 100 smaller things", Adams says. Less driving means cars will need fewer buttons and controls.

13 Digitalization will have an even bigger effect on car design than electrification.

Living room on wheels

14 Hyundai's concept Seven car has lounge chairs that turn. Hyundai calls the car a "living space on wheels".

15 Some new cars will be like a moving room, where drivers will be able to do other things such as watch films, play games, or video call.

First published in *The Guardian*, 11/06/2022

The Guardian

one stop english

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary

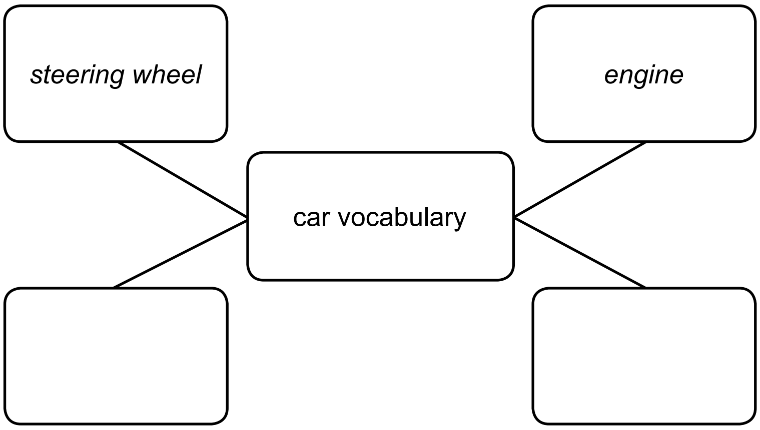
3 Understanding the article

a. Are these statements True or False according to the article? Correct any that are false.

1. The batteries make electric cars a little bit taller than similar non-electric cars.
2. Electric cars need larger engines than non-electric cars.
3. There is not much space for passengers in electric cars.
4. Electric cars have fewer emissions and are easier to recycle.
5. Electrification has a bigger effect on car design than digitization.
6. The cars of the future will have the size and shape of a living room.

4 Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Find all the car words in the article. Write them onto the mind map.



b. Add other car words that you know.

c. Look at the car photos. Describe and compare these two cars with a partner.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary

5 Discussion

a. Discuss the questions.

- When you were a child, what did people think cars of the future would be like?

  When I was a child, people thought that cars of the future …

- What was your first car?

  My first car was a …   I got it in …

- What car would you like to have now?

  I would like to have a … because …

6 In your own words

a. Your task is to get people to change from petrol cars to electric cars.

Make an interesting and informative poster or advert telling your audience at least ten good things about electric cars.

Title: Ten reasons to change to an electric car

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary – Teacher's notes

Article summary: Car design has seen many changes in the past few years. What can we expect to drive and travel around in next?

Time: 90 minutes

Skills: Reading, speaking, writing

Language focus: Vocabulary, speaking, writing

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. Students circle the words in italics they need, making the sentences true. Then they read them out loud.

2. Key words

a. Students write the correct words from the wordpool next to the definitions on the lines provided. Then they find and highlight them in the article to read them in context. Note: the words relating specifically to parts of vehicles will be looked at more closely in exercise 5.

Key:

1. shape
2. replace
3. design
4. space
5. growing
6. emissions
7. reducing
8. fewer
9. materials
10. digitization

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand and know how the words are used in other contexts.

Key:

1. replace
2. shape
3. fewer
4. reducing
5. design

3. Understanding the article

a. Students read the statements and decide whether they are True or False according to the article. They should try to correct any that are false.

Key:

1. True
2. False. Electric cars do not need large engines.
3. False. There is even more space for passengers in electric cars.
4. True
5. False. Digitization has a bigger effect on car design than electrification.
6. False. The cars of the future will have the feel and function of a living room.

4. Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Students work in pairs and follow the instructions on the worksheet, adding all car-related vocabulary they can find in the article to the mind map and then adding other words that they know. Make sure they know there are quite a few differences between the language used in the US and in Britain when talking about cars. Then, using the images as prompts, they should use the vocabulary to talk about cars, car parts, where certain elements are positioned, etc..

5. Discussion

a. Students first think how to complete the sentence prompts for themselves and then use them to start discussing the questions in small groups. If your students are young or have never owned a car, ask them to think about cars that their parents or grandparents have owned or driven.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Elementary – Teacher's notes

6. In your own words

a. Students work in pairs or small groups and do the task using information and language from the lesson. Encourage them to be creative and to share their results with the class. This task can be tweaked depending on the age and focus of your students making it more technical, creative, emotional, sales-orientated, etc., as fits the group's interests. Importantly, they should find ten reasons why people should change to an electric car and write, draw, or record these. Whatever else they decide to add should be encouraged as creative input.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

1 Warmer

a. Briefly discuss this question.

- Petrol, diesel, or electric cars: what are the advantages and disadvantages of each?

2 Key words

a. Find words in the article that match the definitions below. The paragraph numbers are given to help you. Then read the article and notice how the words are used in context.

1. big, wide, and solid ______________________ (paragraph 2)
2. be used instead of something that was used before ______________________ (paragraph 2)
3. companies that make goods in large quantities in a factory ______________________ (paragraph 5)
4. including only the most basic features ______________________ (paragraph 9)
5. the amount of land, energy, water, etc., that a person or organization uses in order to exist or operate ______________________ (paragraph 11)
6. things such as buttons or keys that control the electrical supply to a light, piece of equipment, machine, etc. ______________________ (paragraph 15)
7. turning around on a fixed point so you can face another direction ______________________ (paragraph 17)
8. the inside parts of something, especially a building or vehicle ______________________ (paragraph 19)
9. despite a fact or idea that you have just mentioned: used as a way of showing how a sentence, phrase, or word is related to what has already been said ______________________ (paragraph 19)
10. something you wish for that can never really happen ______________________ (paragraph 19)

b. Use some of the key words above to complete these sentences.

1. No one thought that email would completely ______________________ the traditional business letter.
2. In her heart, she knew that living on a houseboat was probably nothing more than a ______________________.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

3. The company will start to sell a new range of cheaper, ______________________________ products later this year.
4. No one was surprised when Gareth hit the wrong ______________________________ and accidently turned off all the lights.
5. Amy's young son loves ______________________________ on her office chair.
6. Data centres create a large environmental and energy ______________________________.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

Jasper Jolly

11 June, 2022

1 A mechanic working on a Ford Model T 100 years ago would probably understand how any petrol car sold today works. An internal combustion engine at the front turns the wheels, and the driver sits behind a steering wheel.

2 Electric cars change everything. The shape of the car will no longer depend on bulky engines, exhaust gas handling or driveshafts. Digital technology will soon replace everything from rear-view mirrors to the human driver. Never before has the car industry seen so many changes all at once.

3 Here are some of those changes.

'The skateboard'

4 Look at the front of a Tesla and one thing is clear: it doesn't need a grille to provide air to the engine.

5 Other car manufacturers are using the new design freedom to offer retro-futuristic models that might have featured in a 1980s sci-fi film.

6 Electric cars are built with a "skateboard" design, with a flat bed of batteries and wheels and motors at either end. Electric motors are smaller than bulky internal combustion engines, so there is no need for a large bonnet in front of the driver.

More interior space

7 The skateboard means electric cars tend to be a few centimetres taller. Many carmakers have started with bulky sports utility vehicles (SUVs) first so they can fit in more batteries. But there is still more space for passengers.

8 In combustion engine cars, "the mechanics took up a lot of space," says Mark Adams, design director for Vauxhall-Opel.

9 Citroën already has a different option: the Ami is a tiny, no-frills two-seater car for cities. It will sell for less than £8,000 in the UK.

10 In France, anyone over 14 years of age can drive an Ami, with no need for a driving licence.

11 Adams believes the electric revolution could finally stop the move towards bigger SUVs. "The days of the growing cars are gone," he says. "We don't need to have massive footprint cars anymore."

Fewer car parts

12 Producing zero exhaust emissions is one major change. Reducing waste at end of life is another. This can be done by using fewer parts with fewer complicated mixes of materials.

13 For instance, a car's front grille can contain 10 to 15 pieces, so not having one makes it easier to recycle the car. BMW's i Vision Circular is made with only seven materials – all recyclable.

Forget the steering wheel

14 Future cars will probably not need a steering wheel. Driverless cars are already on the roads.

15 Changing "one big thing changes 100 smaller things", Adams says. Less driving means cars will need fewer buttons and switches, providing a cleaner look, which is more about leisure.

16 Overall, digitalization will have an even bigger effect on car design than electrification.

Living room on wheels

17 The Korean carmaker Hyundai's concept Seven vehicle has swivelling lounge chairs. Hyundai calls the car a "living space on wheels". Some new cars will be like a moving extension of home that allows drivers the freedom to do other things.

18 All that free time on the move may give people more time for other activities. Cinema-style projectors or virtual-reality entertainment are two options. Big-tech companies from Apple and Alphabet to Spotify and WeChat believe the car will be the next place where they can sell services such as films, games and music.

19 Eventually, interiors could move from "living room" to "bedroom", although putting beds rather than seats in cars could mean new safety problems. Nevertheless, the idea of going to bed at home and waking up at work, or even in another country, is no longer a Jetsons*-style pipe dream.

**The Jetsons* = a 1960s US animated cartoon series for children about the adventures of a futuristic family in the year 2062

First published in *The Guardian*, 11/06/2022

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

3 Understanding the article

a. Are these statements True or False according to the article? Correct any that are false.

1. A mechanic from one hundred years ago would probably still know how today's electric cars work.
2. For many years, the large engine has affected the shape of a car.
3. At the moment, electric cars are a little bit taller than similar petrol cars.
4. Fewer and less complex parts mean that electric cars are easier to recycle.
5. One big change often means that many other things in a new car design can be changed too.
6. Digitization means that customers can now buy an electric car with either a bedroom or a living-room interior.

4 Key language

a. Use the words in the box to create two-, three-, or four-word phrases that fit with the meanings. Then find them in the article to check your answers.

is at one of futurism to thing all retro tend move once be end on clear the life

1. everything at the same time
2. this much is obvious
3. what people in the past thought the future would be like
4. are usually
5. the time when a product can no longer work or can no longer be used
6. while you are travelling around

b. Now use the phrases to talk about the article.

The Guardian

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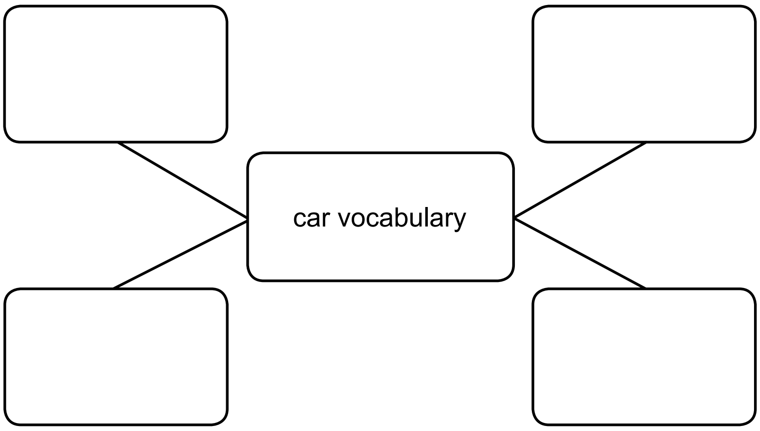
A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

5 Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Find and highlight all the car-related vocabulary in the article. Write it onto the mind map.



b. Add other car vocabulary that you know. Where the words are different in British and American English, write both and add BE or AE to the words.

c. Look at the car images and talk about their parts and features with a partner.

6 Discussion

a. Discuss these questions.

- When you were a child, what did people think cars of the future would be like?
- Roughly, how many cars have you had in your life?
- What was the first?
- Which was your favourite?
- What changes and differences are there between your first and your most recent car?
- What do you like best about driverless/autonomous vehicles?

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate

7 In your own words

a. **Create an interesting and informative poster or advert as part of a project to get people to change to electric vehicles.**

The Guardian

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A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Intermediate – Teacher's notes

Article summary: Car design has seen many changes in the past few years. What can we expect to drive and travel around in next?

Time: 90 minutes

Skills: Reading, speaking, writing

Language focus: Vocabulary, speaking, writing

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. Students briefly discuss the question to introduce the topic of the article.

2. Key words

a. Students find words in the article that match the definitions and write them on the lines provided. Note: the words relating specifically to parts of vehicles will be looked at more closely in exercise 5.

Key:

1. *bulky*
2. *replace*
3. *manufacturers*
4. *no-frills*
5. *footprint*
6. *switches*
7. *swivelling*
8. *interiors*
9. *nevertheless*
10. *pipe dream*

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand and know how the words are used in other contexts.

Key:

1. *replace*
2. *pipe dream*
3. *no-frills*
4. *switches*
5. *swivelling*
6. *footprint*

3. Understanding the article

a. Students read the statements and decide whether they are True or False according to the article. They should correct any that are false.

Key:

1. *False. A mechanic from a century ago would likely still know how today's petrol cars work. They'd unlikely be able to understand an electric car.*
2. *True*
3. *True*
4. *True*
5. *True*
6. *False. Although digitization already allows a car to become more like a living room, making it into a bedroom is trickier but is something that could be available in the future.*

4. Key language

a. Students use the words in the box to create two-, three-, or four-word phrases that fit with the meanings and write them on the lines provided. Then they find them in the article to check their answers before using them to talk about the article.

Key:

1. *all at once*
2. *one thing is clear*
3. *retro futurism*
4. *tend to be*
5. *end of life*
6. *on the move*

5. Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Students work in pairs and follow the instructions on the worksheet, adding all car-related vocabulary they can find in the article to the mind map and then adding other words that they know. Make sure they know there are quite a few differences between the language used in the US and in Britain when talking about cars.

Then, using the images as prompts, they should use the vocabulary to talk about cars, where each item, feature, section or part is found, what it looks like, how it has changed over the years, etc..

6. Discussion

a. Students discuss the questions related to the article, and give their reasons and justifications for each answer, referring to their own experiences wherever possible. Encourage them to use words from the article and lesson plan in their answers, such as *retro futuristic*. If your students are young or have never owned a car, ask them to think about cars that their parents or grandparents have owned or driven.

7. In your own words

a. Students work in pairs or small groups and do the task using information and language from the lesson. Encourage them to be creative and to share their results with the class. This task can be tweaked depending on the age and focus of your students, making it more technical, creative, emotional, sales-orientated, etc., as fits the group's interests.

The Guardian

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A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced

1 Warmer

a. Discuss these two questions briefly.

- What do cars run on?
- What are the advantages and disadvantages of each type of fuel or energy?

2 Key words

a. Write the correct words from the wordpool next to the definitions below. Then find and highlight them in the article to read them in context.

array	bulky	cockpit	consultancies	crucial
dispense with	inevitable	no-frills	notable	pipe dream
pootling	rigidly	striking	switch	swivel

1. done or applied in a strict and uncompromising way with no room for flexibility ______________________
2. big, wide, and solid ______________________
3. attracting your interest or attention because of some unusual feature ______________________
4. unusual or interesting enough to be mentioned or noticed ______________________
5. including only the most basic features and of acceptable quality, but not very high quality ______________________
6. moving around slowly and in a relaxed way, especially in a car ______________________
7. extremely important because it has a major effect on the result of something ______________________
8. no longer using someone or something because you no longer want or need them ______________________
9. impossible to avoid or prevent ______________________
10. something such as a button or a key that controls the electrical supply to a light, piece of equipment, machine, etc. ______________________
11. the part of a plane where the pilot sits and where the controls are ______________________
12. turn around on a fixed point so you are facing in another direction ______________________

13. companies with expert knowledge about a particular subject that provide professional help and advice to other companies ______________________________
14. a large group of things that are related in some way ______________________________
15. something you wish for that can never really happen ______________________________

b. Use some of the key words above to complete these sentences.

1. Most people dressed appropriately for the occasion, with the ______________________________ exception of Paul.
2. Deep down, she knew that living on a houseboat was probably nothing more than a ______________________________.
3. We believe the question being investigated by the Commission is one of ______________________________ importance to the country.
4. It is perhaps ______________________________ that advanced technology will increase the pressure on employees.
5. Daphne's new eye make-up colour is very ______________________________, and it suits her.
6. With so many ______________________________ to choose from, no one was surprised when Gareth hit the wrong one, accidently turning off all the lights.
7. We plan to launch a new range of cheaper, ______________________________ products this autumn.
8. Amy's young son always loved ______________________________ on her office chair.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced

Future EV designs offer drivers more space and leisure with fewer parts, making production more sustainable

Jasper Jolly

11 June, 2022

1 Take any petrol car sold today and show it to a mechanic working on a Ford Model T 100 years ago and there is a fairly good chance they would understand roughly how it works. An internal combustion engine at the front turns the wheels, carrying a driver behind a steering wheel, some passengers and luggage.

2 The advent of electric cars changes everything. No longer will the shape of the car be defined so rigidly by bulky engines, exhaust gas handling or driveshafts. At the same time, digital technology promises to replace everything from rear-view mirrors to the human driver. Never has the car industry had to cope with so many changes all at once.

3 Here are some of the most striking changes we can expect to see.

'The skateboard'

4 Already the lack of an internal combustion engine has had an impact. Look at the front of a Tesla and one thing becomes clear: there is no grille needed to provide air to the engine.

5 Rival manufacturers are using the newfound design freedom to provide models such as the Hyundai Ioniq 5 and the Honda e that go for smaller but stronger lights in a package offering retro futurism that might have featured in a 1980s sci-fi film.

6 Electric cars are built with a "skateboard" design, with a flat bed of batteries and wheels and motors at either end. Electric motors are also smaller than bulky internal combustion engines, meaning there is no need for an expanse of bonnet in front of the driver.

7 The US start-up Canoo is one of the most notable examples of this. Its lifestyle vehicle will have a notably flat front, giving it a boxy shape unlike most modern cars.

More interior space

8 The skateboard means electric cars tend to be a few centimetres taller, and many carmakers have started with bulky sports utility vehicles (SUVs) first so they can fit in more batteries. But there is still more space for passengers.

9 In combustion engine cars, "the mechanics took up a tremendous amount of space," says Mark Adams, design director for Vauxhall-Opel. What that space is repurposed for in an EV is then "really up to the individual vehicle and what you're trying to do as a brand."

10 Citroën has already shown one option: the Ami is a tiny, no-frills two-seater car for pootling around cities. It will launch in the UK at less than £8,000.

11 In France, the Ami can be driven by anyone over 14 years of age, with no need for a driving licence.

12 Adams believes the electric revolution could finally stop the move towards bigger SUVs. "The days of the growing cars are gone," he says. "We don't need to have massive footprint cars anymore."

Fewer car parts

13 Producing zero exhaust emissions is not the only major change to how cars look and feel. Reducing waste at end of life is increasingly seen as crucial for carmakers, and that means using fewer parts with fewer complicated mixes of materials where possible.

14 For instance, a car's front grille can contain 10 to 15 pieces, so dispensing with it reduces complication when it comes to fixing or recycling. BMW's i Vision Circular showed how a car could be made with only seven materials – all recyclable.

Forget the steering wheel

15 The most conspicuous absence in future cars will eventually be the steering wheel. Driverless cars are already on roads, and it seems inevitable that mostly or fully autonomous cars will – eventually – come on to the market.

16 Changing "one big thing changes 100 smaller things", Adams says. Less driving means less need for easily accessed controls, so cars will swap the aeroplane cockpit, stuffed full of buttons and switches, for a cleaner look, which is more about leisure.

17 Overall, digitalization will have an even bigger effect on car design than even electrification.

Living room on wheels

18 The Korean carmaker Hyundai's concept Seven vehicle has swivelling lounge chairs and banquette seating that it describes as a "living space on wheels". It is clear that some cars are going to be treated more as extensions of home that happen to move as drivers are freed to do other things.

19 All that free time on the move may give people more time for other activities. Cinema-style projectors or virtual-reality entertainment are two options in the works. Car consultancies and big-tech companies from Apple and Alphabet to Spotify and WeChat believe the car will be the next place where they can sell a huge array of services such as films, games and music.

20 Eventually, interiors could move from "living room" to "bedroom", although putting beds rather than seats in cars throws up tricky safety problems. Nevertheless, the idea of going to bed at home and waking up at work, or even in another country, is no longer a Jetsons*-style pipe dream.

**The Jetsons* = a 1960s US animated cartoon series for children about the adventures of a futuristic family in the year 2062

First published in *The Guardian*, 11/06/2022

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced

3 Understanding the article

a. Are these statements True or False according to the article? Correct any that are false.

1. A mechanic from a century ago would likely still know how today's electric cars work.
2. For many years, the engine has very much dictated the shape of a car.
3. Currently, electric cars are slightly higher than petrol cars.
4. Changes to the car body make it less likely that it can be repaired or recycled.
5. Making one big change to the way cars are made usually has a knock-on effect meaning that many other things are able to be changed or done away with too.
6. Digitization means that customers can now choose between a bedroom-style car or a living-room-style interior.

4 Key language

a. Find phrases that fit the meanings.

1. quite likely that something will happen (4 words, paragraph 1)
2. the introduction of a new product, idea, custom, etc. (3 words, paragraph 2)
3. made a noticeable difference (3 words, paragraph 4)
4. how people in the past thought the future would look like or be (2 words, paragraph 5)
5. are usually (3 words, paragraph 8)
6. when something is noticeable because it is missing (2 words, paragraph 15)
7. while travelling around (3 words, paragraph 19)
8. being planned or dealt with (3 words, paragraph 19)

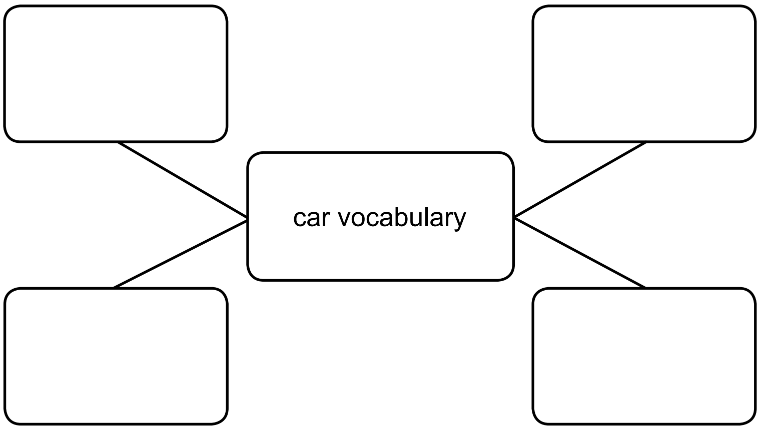
b. Now use them to talk about the article.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced

5 Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Find and highlight all the car-related vocabulary in the article. Write it onto the mind map.



b. Add other car vocabulary that you know. Where the words are different in British and American English, write both alternatives and add BE or AE to the words.

c. Look at the car images and talk about their parts and features with a partner.

6 Discussion

a. Discuss these questions.

- When you were a child, what did people imagine cars of the future would be like?
- Roughly, how many cars have you had in your life?
- What was the first?
- Which was your favourite?
- What notable changes and differences are there between your first and your most recent car?
- What appeals to you most about driverless/autonomous vehicles?

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced

7 In your own words

a. **Create an interesting and informative poster or advert to encourage people to change to electric vehicles.**

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced – Teacher's notes

Article summary: Car design has seen many changes in the past few years. What can we expect to drive and travel around in next?

Time: 90 minutes

Skills: Reading, speaking, writing

Language focus: Vocabulary, speaking, writing

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. Students briefly discuss the two questions to introduce the topic of the article.

2. Key words

a. Students write the correct word from the wordpool next to the definitions on the lines provided. Then students find and highlight them in the article to read them in context. Note: the words relating specifically to parts of vehicles will be looked at more closely in exercise 5.

Key:

1. *rigidly*
2. *bulky*
3. *striking*
4. *notable*
5. *no-frills*
6. *pootling*
7. *crucial*
8. *dispense with*
9. *inevitable*
10. *switch*
11. *cockpit*
12. *swivel*
13. *consultancies*
14. *array*
15. *pipe dream*

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand and know how the words are used in other contexts.

Key:

1. *notable*
2. *pipe dream*
3. *crucial*
4. *inevitable*
5. *striking*
6. *switches*
7. *no-frills*
8. *swivelling*

3. Understanding the article

a. Students read the statements and decide whether they are True or False according to the article. They should correct any that are false in detail.

Key:

1. *False. A mechanic from a century ago would likely still know how today's petrol cars work. They'd not be able to understand an electric car.*
2. *True*
3. *True*
4. *False. Doing away with certain parts and using a less complicated mix of materials make it more likely that the parts can be fixed or recycled.*
5. *True*
6. *False. Although digitization already allows a car to become more like a living room, making it into a bedroom is trickier but is something that could be available in the future.*

4. Key language

a. Students find phrases that fit with the meanings.

Key:

1. *a fairly good chance*
2. *the advent of*
3. *had an impact*
4. *retro futurism*
5. *tend to be*
6. *conspicuous absence*
7. *on the move*
8. *in the works*

b. Then they use them to talk about the article.

A living room on a skateboard: how electric vehicles are redefining the car

Level: Advanced – Teacher's notes

5. Car and vehicle vocabulary

a. Students work in pairs and follow the instructions on the worksheet, adding all car-related vocabulary they can find in the article to the mind map and then adding other words that they know. Make sure they know there are quite a few differences between the language used in the US and in the UK when talking about cars.

Then, using the images as prompts, they should use the vocabulary to talk about cars, where each item, feature, section, or part is found, what it looks like, how it has changed over the years, etc..

6. Discussion

a. Students discuss the questions related to the article, and give their reasons and justifications for each answer, referring to their own experiences wherever possible. Encourage them to use words from the article and lesson plan in their answers, such as *retro futuristic*. If your students are young or have never owned a car, ask them to think about cars that their parents or grandparents have owned or driven.

7. In your own words

a. Students work in pairs or small groups and do the task using information and language from the lesson. Encourage them to be creative and to share their results with the class. This task can be tweaked depending on the age and focus of your students, making it more technical, creative, emotional, sales-orientated, etc., as fits the group's interests.